GYR-O Pages: call card

Devan Cherie Costa-Cargill · Wyoming SBDC, Powell · Fri 23 Oct, 1:00–1:30 · 307-254-7755 · dcostaca@uwyo.edu

SAY FIRST, ABOUT A MINUTE

- "Thanks for the time. I'm Walter Wilkinson, a retired technology engineer in Worland."
- "On June 3 of this year Governor Gordon issued an executive order calling for state agencies to promote data centers, the buildings AI runs on. But it looks like the state's AI money will be going to Cheyenne and Laramie. Here in Washakie County we will not be building any colossal data centers, and will not be hosting any AI researchers. My proposal answers the question: how can we bring AI to the grass-roots level?"
- "AI does the heavy lifting: simple single-topic websites, where the owner just picks a name. Three are live, including washakie-ai.online. The technology is working now. What I'm looking for is the next step: the right people at UW, and funding for a county pilot."

Then stop talking. Let her ask.

ASK, IN THIS ORDER

1. **UW.** Who in Laramie should see this? One person in Extension, one on the AI side (AI4WY). Would you introduce me?
2. **Market research.** Can the SBDC run it on this, free? What do you need from me?
3. **Sponsor.** Which Washakie County body has sponsored a Business Council grant before, and who there?
4. **Is the grant open?** The $10,000 Community Economic Growth Grant page still says "reopening by January 2024."
5. **If not that grant,** what is the right one for a $10,000 rural technology pilot?

IF SHE ASKS "BUSINESS OR COMMUNITY PROGRAM?"

> **"A business. The school pilot is the market test; the grant would fund the pilot."**

IN MY POCKET, ONLY IF IT COMES UP

- **Cost to an owner:** hosting free; the name $11–$28 a year; a farm cooperative can share one name.
- **The pilot:** 12 months, 12 working sites, 4 public workshops, method published free.
- **Students** do the demonstrations and gather feedback; they don't build the sites.
- **SBIR/STTR:** federal research grants. STTR needs a university partner; ask, don't count on it.
- **Numbers behind the rural point:** Governor Gordon's executive order, 3 June 2026; 1.8 GW data center approved in Laramie County; about $4M NSF to UW's AI4WY.

BEFORE HANGING UP

- Leave with one next step on the calendar: an introduction, a market-research start, or a follow-up date.